

fails a Stamina roll (difficulty 8). Botching the Stamina roll causes the opponent to be stunned for two turns.

Roll: Dexterity + Melee **Difficulty:** 7

Damage: Strength +2/L

Sweep: The attacker attempts to knock her foe's legs out from under him, knocking him down (see knockdown, p. 283). Attackers can either use their legs (Dexterity + Brawl) or a weapon at least as long as their forearm (Dexterity + Melee). This attack does no damage, but if it succeeds, the opponent is automatically knocked down.

Roll: Dexterity + Brawl (or Melee) **Difficulty:** 8

Damage: None

Tendon Slice: An unscrupulous attacker using a bladed weapon can specifically target her opponent's ankles or wrists and attempt to cut the tendons there, crippling that limb. A successful attack on an opponent's leg means the opponent can move no faster than two yards/meters per turn until the injury heals and adds +2 to the difficulty of any rolls to avoid being knocked down. A successful attack on an arm prevents the opponent from using that hand and causes him to drop anything held in it.

Roll: Dexterity + Melee **Difficulty:** 9

Damage: Weapon damage + crippling

Weapon Strike: The most basic form of attack with a weapon. The character swings her sword, axe, or club at her opponent. The roll's difficulty and damage are unmodified.

Roll: Dexterity + Brawl or Melee **Difficulty:** 6

Damage: Weapon damage

Mounted Combat

Many of the Kithain find great majesty and power in riding into combat on a loyal steed. In practice, a real horse requires considerable amounts of land, time, and money to keep. In addition, riding around in armor while bearing weapons attracts notice and often the police. Chimerical horses are easier, but can be banished by Banality if a mortal sees the rider "floating" in midair. Also, while riding in combat, none of the rider's combat dice pools can exceed Dexterity + Ride – a poor rider cannot effectively fight on horseback. This limit applies to close combat, ranged combat, and defensive maneuvers.

Unless the character is riding a trained warhorse, the horse is likely to shy, buck, or simply run away if confronted with sudden loud noises (like those in combat) or injured. Even on a warhorse, the rider needs to make a reflexive ride roll to keep control of a horse in combat (difficulty 6 for loud noises or sudden bright lights, difficulty 7 if the horse is wounded). Failing this roll means the horse attempts to flee, and a botch means the rider is thrown off and usually suffers two dice of bashing damage if the horse was trotting and three dice if the horse was galloping. Warhorse breeds still exist, but finding a trained warhorse is exceptionally difficult. Anyone wishing such a horse usually must train it herself.

Regardless of their nature, horses can be exceedingly useful in close combat. A trained warhorse can attack independently of her rider, allowing the horse and rider to each attack the



Horses & Warhorses

The following are Traits for an ordinary riding horse:

Attributes: Strength 5, Dexterity 2, Stamina 4, Perception 3, Intelligence 2, Wits 2

Abilities: Alertness 3, Athletics 3, Brawl 1, Empathy 2

Willpower: 2

Health Levels: OK, OK, OK, OK, -1, -3, -3, -3, -5, -5, Incapacitated

Armor Rating: 1 (five soak dice, total)

Attack: Trample or kick for six dice (bashing); bite for three (lethal).

Movement: Horses move roughly twice as fast as humans. Horses can walk, trot, or gallop. If walking, horses move at 12 yards/meters per turn. If trotting, horses move at (25 + Dexterity) yards/meters per turn. If galloping, horses move at (40 + [5 x Dexterity]) yards/meters per turn.

Horse Types

Light warhorse: Raise Dexterity, Brawl, and Willpower to 3.

Heavy warhorse: Raise Stamina to 5, and raise Brawl and Willpower to 3.

Fae Warhorse: Raise Dexterity & Willpower to 4, raise Intelligence and Brawl to 3. Increased movement: Fae warhorses walk at 15 yards/meters per turn, trot at (30 + Dexterity) yards/meters per turn, and gallop at (50 + [6 x Dexterity]) yards/meters per turn. These creatures are always chimerical.



same target or the horse to engage in close combat with one target while the rider shoots someone else with a bow or a gun. Attackers who ride a horse into close combat can also use the horse's momentum to boost their damage. Any mounted close combat attack automatically gains +2 damage dice if the horse is trotting and +4 damage dice if the horse is galloping. Also, riding characters can move at half the horse's galloping speed without spending an action on movement, allowing them to enter or leave combat very rapidly.

Fighting while riding a motorcycle has many of the same limitations and advantages as fighting on a horse, especially if the motorcycle is designed for off-road use. When riding a motorcycle, combat dice pools cannot exceed the rider's Dexterity + Drive dice pool, and the rider gains the same additional damage dice when riding the motorcycle into close combat. However, unless they are exceptionally magical, motorcycles cannot fight opponents on their own. See Stunt Driving (p. 253) for further details.

